



REPUBLIC OF KENYA



# GARISSA COUNTY SOCIAL PROTECTION POLICY



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DEPARTMENT OF GENDER, SOCIAL SERVICES, CULTURE, YOUTH AND SPORTS  
DIRECTORATE OF SOCIAL SERVICES AND PERSONS WITH DISABILITIES

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# 2025





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**For further information, please contact:**

Chief Officer

Department of Gender, Social Services, Culture, Youth and Sports, Garissa County

Email: [xxx](mailto:xxx)

Website: [www.garissa.go.ke](http://www.garissa.go.ke)





# Foreword

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**It is with great pride and a deep sense of responsibility that I present this Social Protection Policy. This document is not just a policy framework; it is a commitment to uplift the lives of our citizens in Garissa County, ensuring that every individual has access to the basic dignities of life.**

Social protection plays a crucial role in promoting equity, addressing vulnerabilities and reducing poverty in our communities. Garissa County, with its unique challenges such as economic disparities, recurrent droughts and insecurity, recognizes that a robust social protection system is essential for fostering resilience among our people.

This policy outlines our strategic approach to providing support to the most vulnerable members of our communities, including orphans, persons with disabilities, the elderly and those affected by economic shocks. By integrating various social protection programs such as cash transfers, food assistance, and livelihood support, we aim to create a safety net that empowers individuals and promotes self-reliance.

In developing this policy, we engaged with a multitude of stakeholders, including community members, technical team from county and national government, development and humanitarian partners and private sector to ensure that our interventions are tailored to the specific needs of our county. It is through this collaborative effort that we seek to promote inclusivity and build a strong social contract between the government and its citizens.

As we move forward with the implementation of this policy, I urge all stakeholders involved to work together with commitment and diligence. Our success will be measured not just by the policies we enact, but by the tangible improvements in the lives of our people. Together, we can build a more resilient Garissa where every individual has the opportunity to thrive.

**H.E Nathif Jama Adam**  
Governor, Garissa County



# Preface

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**The Garissa County Social Protection Policy 2025 is a strategic framework designed to provide inclusive and sustainable social protection programs that address the needs of vulnerable populations, including children, the elderly, persons with disabilities and marginalized groups.**

Social protection is a fundamental human right and a key driver of sustainable development. In Garissa County, where socio-economic vulnerabilities such as poverty, food insecurity, and climate-related shocks are prevalent, social protection plays an important role in safeguarding livelihoods and fostering resilience. **The Garissa County Social Protection Policy 2025** is a strategic framework designed to provide inclusive and sustainable social protection programs that address the needs of vulnerable populations, including children, the elderly, persons with disabilities and marginalized groups.

This policy aligns with Kenya's Vision 2030, The Fourth Medium Term Plan (MTP IV), **The National Social Protection Policy (2023)**, and international frameworks such as the Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs). It is structured around four key pillars: **Income Security, Social Health Protection, and Shock-Responsive Social Protection and Complementary Programs** ensuring a holistic and coordinated approach to vulnerability and poverty reduction and economic empowerment.

The development of this policy has been an inclusive and participatory process, with extensive stakeholder engagement. It provides a roadmap for strengthening social protection systems, enhancing policy coordination, and fostering strategic partnerships to achieve long-term socio-economic stability in Garissa County.

As we implement this policy, I urge all stakeholders—including government institutions, humanitarian and development partners, civil society organizations, and the private sector—to collaborate in ensuring its success. Together, we can create a just and equitable society where every resident of Garissa County has access to essential social protection services, enabling them to live dignified and productive lives.

**Hon. Hawa Abdi Sahal**  
County Executive Committee Member

**Department of Gender, Social Services, Culture, Youth and Sports**  
**Garissa County**



# Acknowledgements



## **The Garissa County Social Protection Policy 2025 was made possible through the dedication and collective efforts of various stakeholders.**

The successful development of the Garissa County Social Protection Policy 2025 was made possible through the dedication and collective efforts of various stakeholders. We extend our sincere appreciation to H.E the Governor Garissa County for his support and unwavering commitment to advancing social protection for all residents of the County.

We also acknowledge the technical directors and their deputies led by the leadership of director social protection for their invaluable technical expertise, inputs and insights throughout the policy formulation process starting with the preliminary discussions and the first technical drafting all the way to the finalization.

Our fortitude extends to the State Department for Social Protection, Social Protection Secretariat, State Department for Economic Planning, Kenya Institute of Public Policy Research and Analysis and Council of Governors whose technical guidance were crucial in ensuring the successful drafting and validation of this policy.

Finally, we extend our deepest appreciation to the development and humanitarian partners led by UNICEF whose financial and technical contributions enriched the policy with the best practices and innovative approaches.

The input from the residents of Garissa County, gathered through consultative forums and public participation sessions, has been instrumental in shaping this policy to reflect the needs and aspirations of the people.

We look forward to the effective implementation of this policy to transform the lives of vulnerable populations and build a more inclusive and resilient Garissa County.

**Bilal Osman Mohamed**

Director Youth Affairs

*Garissa County*



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# Abbreviations and Acronyms

|               |                                                         |
|---------------|---------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>ASALs</b>  | Arid and Semi-Arid Lands                                |
| <b>AGPO</b>   | Access to Government Procurement Opportunities          |
| <b>CBOs</b>   | Community-Based Organizations                           |
| <b>CIMES</b>  | County Integrated Monitoring and Evaluation System      |
| <b>CSOs</b>   | Civil Society Organizations                             |
| <b>CIDP</b>   | County Integrated Development Plan                      |
| <b>CSPMIS</b> | County Social Protection Management Information System  |
| <b>CSPTWG</b> | County Social Protection Technical Working Group        |
| <b>DTP</b>    | Diphtheria-Tetanus-Pertussis                            |
| <b>FGM</b>    | Female Genital Mutilation                               |
| <b>GBV</b>    | Gender-Based Violence                                   |
| <b>GDP</b>    | Gross Domestic Product                                  |
| <b>GER</b>    | Gross Enrollment Rate                                   |
| <b>GIS</b>    | Geographic Information System                           |
| <b>GII</b>    | Gender Inequality Index                                 |
| <b>ILO</b>    | International Labour Organization                       |
| <b>KDHS</b>   | Kenya Demographic and Health Survey                     |
| <b>KNBS</b>   | Kenya National Bureau of Statistics                     |
| <b>KIPPRA</b> | Kenya Institute for Public Policy Research and Analysis |
| <b>MIS</b>    | Management Information System                           |
| <b>MTP</b>    | Medium-Term Plan                                        |
| <b>NCPWD</b>  | National Council for Persons with Disabilities          |
| <b>NDMA</b>   | National Drought Management Authority                   |
| <b>NER</b>    | Net Enrollment Rate                                     |
| <b>NSSF</b>   | National Social Security Fund                           |
| <b>OVC</b>    | Orphans and Vulnerable Children                         |
| <b>PPPs</b>   | Public-Private Partnerships                             |
| <b>PWDs</b>   | Persons with Disabilities                               |
| <b>SDGs</b>   | Sustainable Development Goals                           |
| <b>SHIF</b>   | Social Health Insurance Fund                            |
| <b>SGBV</b>   | Sexual and Gender-Based Violence                        |
| <b>SPMIS</b>  | Social Protection Management Information System         |
| <b>UHC</b>    | Universal Health Coverage                               |
| <b>UNHCR</b>  | United Nations High Commissioner for Refugees           |
| <b>WASH</b>   | Water, Sanitation, and Hygiene                          |

# Definition of Terms

|                                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
|---------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Social Protection :</b>                  | A set of policies, programs, and legislative measures designed to reduce poverty, vulnerability and risks by providing income support, healthcare and other essential services.                              |
| <b>Income Security :</b>                    | Financial support mechanisms aimed at ensuring individuals and households have stable and sufficient income to meet basic needs.                                                                             |
| <b>Social Health Protection :</b>           | Measures that provide access to affordable healthcare and financial risk protection against health-related expenses.                                                                                         |
| <b>Shock-Responsive Social Protection :</b> | A social protection framework designed to provide timely assistance in response to economic, environmental, or social shocks, such as natural disasters, pandemics, or displacement.                         |
| <b>Universal Health Coverage (UHC) :</b>    | A system ensuring that all individuals and communities have access to essential healthcare services without financial hardship.                                                                              |
| <b>Cash Transfers :</b>                     | Direct monetary payments provided to eligible individuals or households to support their well-being and economic stability.                                                                                  |
| <b>Vulnerable Groups :</b>                  | Populations at high risk of poverty, exclusion, or social disadvantages, including persons with disabilities (PWDs), elderly persons, refugees, and marginalized communities.                                |
| <b>Disability Inclusion :</b>               | The process of ensuring persons with disabilities have equal access to opportunities, resources, and social protection services.                                                                             |
| <b>Gender-Based Violence (GBV) :</b>        | Any form of violence directed at an individual based on their gender, including domestic violence, sexual assault, and harmful cultural practices such as Female Genital Mutilation (FGM).                   |
| <b>Poverty Alleviation :</b>                | Strategies aimed at reducing poverty levels through economic empowerment, financial aid, and access to essential services.                                                                                   |
| <b>Social Assistance :</b>                  | Non-contributory support programs such as food aid, school feeding programs, and emergency relief for the poor and vulnerable.                                                                               |
| <b>Public-Private Partnership (PPP) :</b>   | Collaboration between government agencies and private sector actors to enhance service delivery, including financing and implementing social protection initiatives.                                         |
| <b>Stakeholder Engagement :</b>             | The involvement of various parties, including government, non-governmental organizations (NGOs), community-based organizations (CBOs), and international partners, in policy development and implementation. |
| <b>Early Warning Systems :</b>              | Mechanisms used to detect and respond to risks such as droughts, conflicts, or economic crises before they escalate.                                                                                         |

# Executive Summary



**The Garissa County Social Protection Policy serves as a transformative approach to empower vulnerable populations, enhance resilience, and promote sustainable development.**

The Garissa County Social Protection Policy is a comprehensive policy framework designed to enhance the welfare and resilience of vulnerable populations in the county. The policy which is a product of multi-sectoral and multi-stakeholder consultations and input is structured around four strategic pillars: Income Security, Social Health Protection, Shock Responsive Social Protection and Complementary Programs.

The income security pillar aims to provide economic stability for the most vulnerable groups including elderly, Persons with disability, children, women, youth and marginalized groups. By implementing cash transfer programs, social grants and other support for sustainable livelihoods, the policy seeks to reduce poverty and enhance the economic capacity of households, thereby ensuring that all residents can meet their basic needs.

The Social Health Protection recognizes the critical link between health and socio-economic well-being. This pillar focuses on providing accessible and affordable healthcare services. The policy promotes the establishment of community health insurance schemes and subsidized health services, ensuring that all residents, particularly the most vulnerable and disadvantaged receive necessary medical care without incurring the prohibitive health expenditures.

The Shock Responsive Social Protection pillar emphasizes the need for adaptive social protection systems in light of the recurrent shocks faced by the county such as drought, floods and other catastrophes. The policy will implement mechanisms for rapid response to crises, including emergency cash transfers, food assistance and rehabilitation programs, ensuring that communities can quickly recover and rebuild their livelihoods post-crisis.

The complementary programs pillar encompasses a range of supportive initiatives designed to augment the core social protection strategies implemented by the national government and complementing partners. These include education support, vocational training, skills development programs, and community empowerment initiatives that foster social cohesion and enhance the overall quality of life.

Additionally, robust coordination structures are established to ensure effective implementation of the social protection interventions in the county by promoting synergy and coordination among stakeholders.

To achieve the objectives of this policy effectively, a multi-sectoral coordination framework will be established both at the county, sub-county and wards levels as well as technical coordination forum. This will enhance collaboration between government agencies, development and humanitarian partners, non-governmental and community-based organizations and private sector stakeholders. Regular monitoring and evaluation will be conducted to assess the impact of the initiatives and ensure that policies adapt to the evolving needs of the community.

In summary, the Garissa County Social Protection Policy serves as a transformative approach to empower vulnerable populations, enhance resilience and promote sustainable development. By fostering inclusive growth and ensuring equitable access to basic social services, Garissa County aims to create a more secure and thriving environment for all its residents.



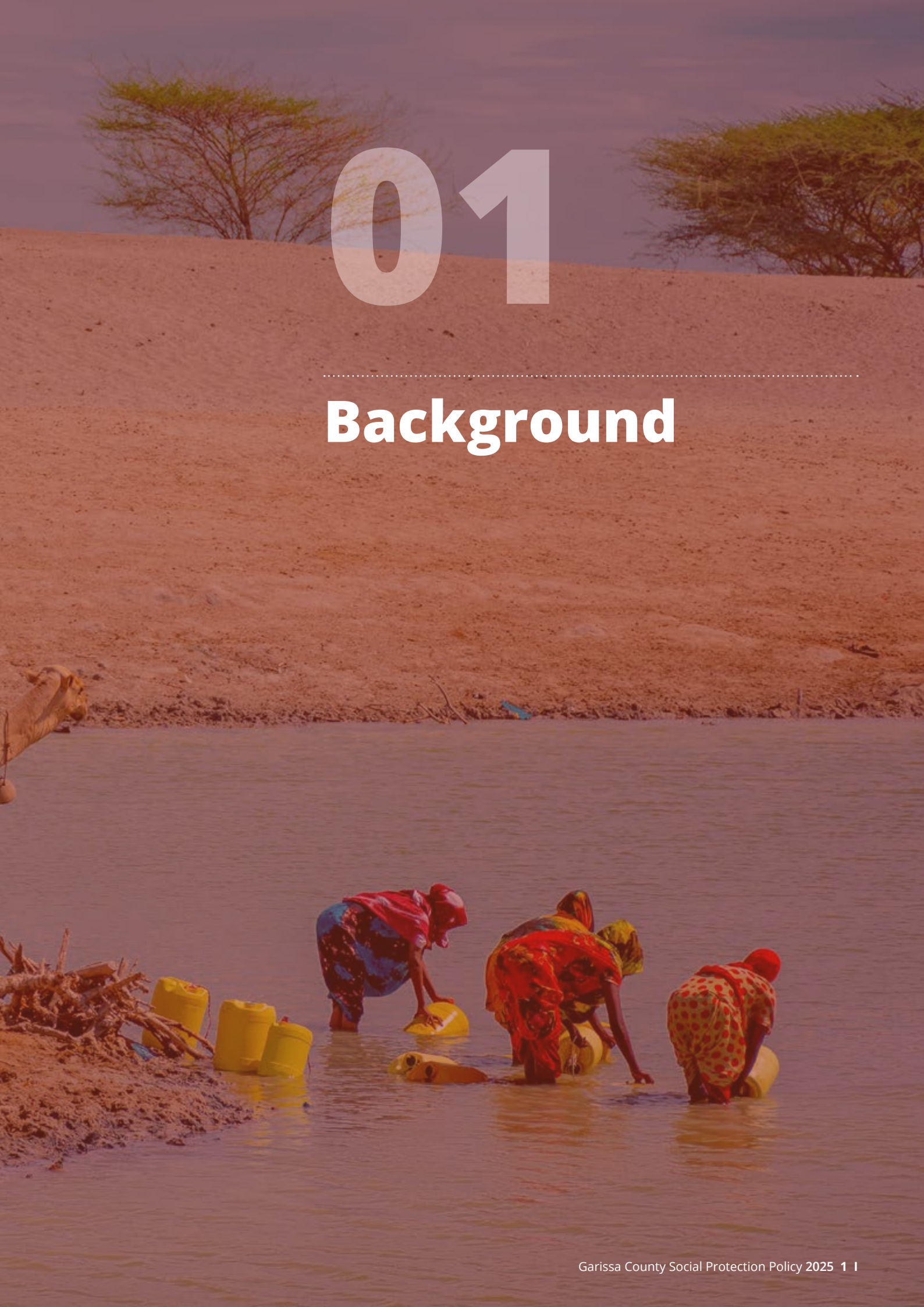




# 01

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## Background





# 1.1 Introduction

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Garissa County is in Northeastern Kenya, shares border with Wajir, Isiolo, and Tana River counties, as well as Somalia. It covers around 44,753 square kilometers and features predominantly arid and semi-arid landscapes.

Economically, Garissa County is largely dependent on pastoralism, with livestock farming being the primary source of income for most households. This reliance on livestock, however, makes the population vulnerable to the impacts of climate change, such as prolonged droughts, which threaten livestock production and livelihoods. Crop farming is minimal due to the arid environment, although irrigation along River Tana supports some agricultural activities. Social protection remains a critical issue in Garissa, as poverty rates are high, exacerbated by food insecurity, periodic droughts, and limited healthcare and educational facilities.

The county also has the Dadaab refugee complex that hosts 383,000 refugees (UNHCR May, 2024). Similarly, the county has 5,187 PWDs (2019 Kenya Population and Housing Census) and made efforts to support PWDs through dedicated initiatives and government support structures by establishing a PWDs Directorate to ensure representation and inclusion in administrative processes. The lack of robust social protection systems means that vulnerable groups, especially the elderly, women, PWDs and children face significant hardship.

The Kenya Social Protection Policy (2023) introduces a rights-based, life-cycle approach to social protection, aimed at safeguarding rights to social security, basic education, healthcare, nutrition, food security, and employment. This policy aligns with Article 43 of Kenya's Constitution, which mandates the progressive realization of economic and social rights and supports the global agenda for Universal Social Protection.

This policy would be essential for alleviating poverty, reducing vulnerability and promoting resilience by fostering an environment that supports both economic growth and social stability.

# 1.2 Rationale for the Policy

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The policy will address multiple vulnerabilities, focusing on income security, healthcare access, and support for basic needs. Currently, social assistance in Garissa remains fragmented and insufficiently resourced, with limited coordination among various government and non-governmental initiatives. A county-led social protection policy will ensure that support reaches those most in need in a systematic and sustained manner. It will also enable Garissa County to address the unique socio-economic conditions of its residents, tailoring support programs that consider both the challenges induced by poverty and the cultural context.

Global best practices emphasize the positive economic impact of social protection policies, especially in low-income and vulnerable regions. Well-implemented social protection programs are shown to stimulate local economies by increasing purchasing power, generating jobs, and supporting micro-enterprises. In this regard, Garissa County stands to benefit not only socially but also economically, as improved household income security can lead to greater economic productivity and stability. A strong social protection framework can thus reduce the county's dependence on emergency aid, building resilience and empowering citizens to achieve self-sufficiency.

Social protection has proven to be an effective tool in reducing poverty, improving resilience, and reducing inequality, making a strong case for the County Government to provide structured support to these vulnerable populations. Addressing Garissa's complex social protection needs requires a comprehensive, coordinated approach that strengthens existing programs, expands coverage and develops innovative interventions tailored to the county's unique context.

Finally, the social protection policy aligns with Kenya's Vision 2030 and the Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs), particularly in reducing poverty, promoting equality, and fostering inclusive development. With Kenya's national policy framework already supporting social protection measures, Garissa County has a strategic opportunity to implement complementary policies and programs that address local challenges.

Establishing a robust social protection policy for Garissa will not only demonstrate commitment to improving the lives of vulnerable populations but also strengthen the county's social contract with its citizens, reinforcing trust and accountability in public governance.

# 1.3 Guiding Principles

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The implementation of this policy will be based on the Constitution, which guarantees the Rights of citizens and mandates the County Government to uphold these rights. In addition, the implementation of the Policy will be guided by a set of core principles, namely:

- **Inclusive life cycle approach:** addressing challenges faced by citizens of all ages.
- **Rights-based approach:** the provision and implementation of Social Protection shall take note of every citizen.
- **Equity, non-discrimination and social justice:** building a more equitable society
- **Gender mainstreaming:** promoting equal rights and opportunities for all genders in the design and implementation of Social Protection interventions.
- **Leadership and integrity:** providing leadership and integrity for the Social Protection sector, in line with Chapter 6 of the Constitution of Kenya.
- **Good governance, accountability and public participation:** Integrating inclusive and civic participation in Social Protection programs for Accountability and transparency.
- **Sustainability:** Ensure sustainability and quality of benefits and services, in line with the country's economic status.
- **Flexibility and responsiveness:** The system will respond to emergencies and social and economic shocks within changing contexts through coordinated institutional channels.
- **Evidence-based:** Ensure that Social Protection Policy and Programs are informed by the evidence generated through Monitoring, Evaluation, Research and Learning (MERL), conducted regularly.
- **Common standards:** State and non-State actors involved in implementing and supporting Social Protection will commit to common sets of performance and financial management standards and reporting procedures.

## 1.4 Policy Statement

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This policy aims to establish a framework for implementing social protection initiatives and strategies in Garissa County. Its aim is to address identified challenges and foster effective partnership with relevant institutions and stakeholders to achieve the desired goals. The policy is structured into three main pillars: Income Security, Social Health Protection and Shock-Responsive interventions.

## 1.5 Scope of the Policy

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The Garissa County Social Protection Policy 2024 will encompass a wide range of social protection programs aimed at improving the wellbeing of vulnerable individuals and households facing economic hardships such as lack of access to basic needs and services. They include marginalized groups such as women, youth, persons with disabilities, the elderly, refugees and internally displaced persons. The scope of the policy includes but is not limited to cash transfer programs for economically disadvantaged households, income-generating initiatives and microfinance support, food security, social health protection and nutrition enhancement programs, inclusive economic development initiatives for refugees and internally displaced persons, minority and marginalized groups, disaster preparedness and response mechanisms, social cohesion and community empowerment projects.

## 1.6 Policy Development Process

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The development of this policy adopted a consultative and participatory approach which enhanced the findings of the desk research on social protection, the legal frameworks and the social protection situation in Garissa County. The drafting process began with a week-long forum where the county government department of social protection and the partners led by UNICEF had preliminary discussions on the social protection environment and the policy gaps. The county technical team were sensitized about social protection, followed by in-depth consultations with stakeholders (within and outside the County) and formation of a County Social Protection Technical Working Group (CSPTWG) which supported the consultation and collation of input of the process.

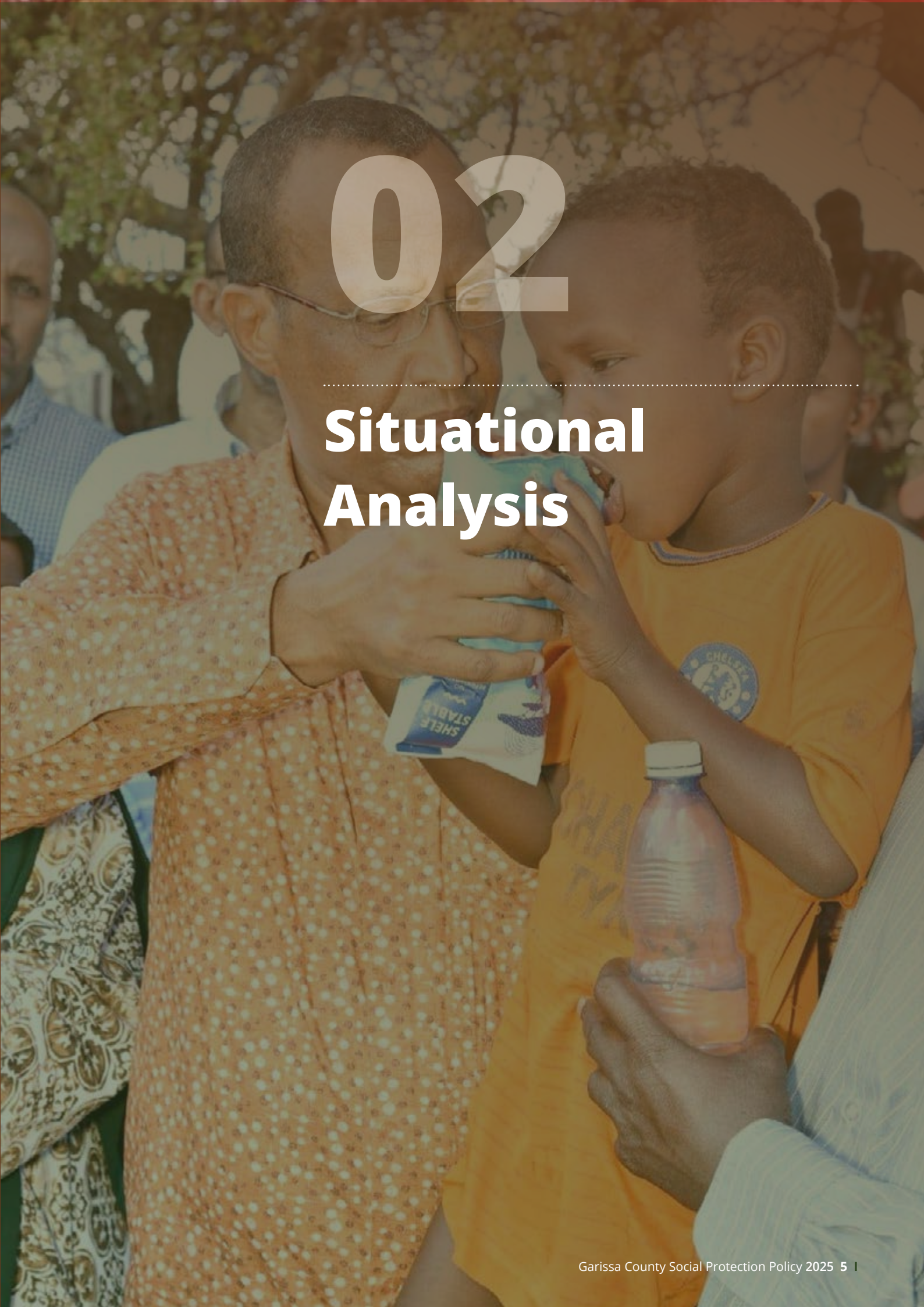
The process continued with first technical drafting of the policy which brought together technical and resource persons from the county, State Department for Social Protection, council of governors, KIPPRA and the UN partner agencies. The second technical drafting did further fine tuning of the policy document with additional input and adjustments.

The draft policy was thereafter validated by the CSPTWG, the Garissa County Executive Committee Members (CECMs), the Gender and Social Services committee of the County Assembly and public participation forums. All the input and feedback received were incorporated into the policy.

Finally, the policy was fine-tuned and subsequently forwarded to the CECM responsible for social protection matters for further tabling to the County Executive for adoption. This resulted into the approval of the policy by the executive and the launching.







# 02

## Situational Analysis



**This chapter presents a situational analysis of Garissa County, focusing on socio-economic factors that contribute to its vulnerabilities, such as high poverty rates, low educational attainment, health challenges, and inadequate Water, Sanitation, and Hygiene (WASH) services. It outlines the county's socio-economic profile, highlighting barriers faced by its predominantly pastoral population, including limited access to services and the adverse impacts of climate-related disasters like droughts and floods. It also reviews current policy and legal frameworks for social protection both at national and county level, aimed at addressing economic vulnerabilities. Additionally, it underscores the need for stronger support for marginalized groups, including persons with disabilities, women, children and refugees advocating for enhanced policy interventions to mitigate risks, build community resilience, and promote socio-economic inclusion.**

## 2.1 Socio-economic context

The socio-economic context will give a background overview of various economic elements that contribute to Garissa County's specific vulnerabilities including county poverty level, illiteracy level, unemployment, insecurity and other social challenges.

### 2.1.1 County Poverty Level

Garissa County, part of Kenya's arid and semi-arid lands, faces frequent droughts, floods and limited livelihoods, keeping many residents in poverty and vulnerability. The county has four livelihood zones: pastoral (90% of residents), agro-pastoral (7%), and formal and wage employment (5%) (National Drought Management Authority, 2023).

In 2021, absolute poverty levels were 67.8%, food poverty 51.2%, and hardcore poverty 21.1%, higher than the national rates of 39.8%, 31.7%, and 7.1% (KNBS, 2022). The county's high poverty level constrains access to essentials like food, WASH, health, nutrition, and housing.

Garissa's monetary poverty rate is 64.2%, with about 540,513 residents considered monetarily poor. Multidimensional poverty is 69%, affecting 580,819 people. With 111,616 children under five, there is need for improved immunization, maternal health facilities, and expanded Early Childhood Development Education (ECDE). The primary school-age group (6-13) has 239,035 children, with more boys. The secondary school-age group (13-17) has 209,902 children, with girls' transition rates affected by early marriage and a nomadic lifestyle.

The youth population (15-29) totals 266,436 and women of reproductive age (15-49) number 207,553, with high fertility linked to low contraceptive use. Persons with disabilities make up 18,424, a figure likely to rise with the population, signaling a need for further surveys on disability (KNBS, 2019).

The county hosts 75,019 households of refugees and asylum seekers with a population of 382,596. Women and children are the majority in the Dadaab camps, where 57% are under 18. The camps house 254,084 refugees and 128,512 asylum seekers (UNHCR, May 2024). This influx of refugees and asylum seekers places immense pressure on Garissa County's social protection systems. With women and children making up a large portion of the population, particularly in the Dadaab camps, the demand for essential social services such as healthcare, education, and child protection far exceeds the county's available resources. This high concentration of vulnerable populations in need of comprehensive social support strains the county's infrastructure and limits its ability to provide effective and inclusive social protection to both the host community and refugees, thus hindering long-term sustainable development efforts.

Gender inequality is significant in Garissa, with a Gender Inequality Index (GII) of 0.468 compared to the national 0.622, indicating losses in human development. Poverty rates are higher among women, and while government and partner programs target gender-related poverty, many remain at the micro-level, limiting their impact on economic transformation for women.

### 2.1.2 Education

The literacy rate in Garissa County is 39.7%, significantly lower than the national average of 61.5%, which impacts youth and adult development, limiting opportunities for quality jobs and poverty reduction. Formal school enrolment has shown improvement over time, yet remains low (KDHS, 2022). In 2023, the county's pre-primary gross enrolment rate (GER) was 56.5% compared to the national rate of 111.2%, indicating limited access for many young children. This disparity affects future development, as early education is crucial in building human capital and addressing socio-economic inequalities, laying a foundation for equitable educational opportunities.

At other educational levels, enrolment remains low. The primary Net enrolment ratio (NER) was 26.7% in 2023, far below the national rate of 79.3%, leaving approximately 83% of primary-aged children without schooling. The secondary NER was even lower, at 9.9% compared to the national 54.1%. Gender parity is yet to be achieved; the Gender Parity Index (GPI) for pre-primary is 0.81, primary 0.73, and secondary 0.68, all trailing national averages, highlighting that fewer girls access education compared to boys (Education sector report 2023).

Key barriers to education in Garissa include high poverty rates, limited financial resources, inadequate school infrastructure, and climate challenges such as droughts and floods. Social and cultural factors also play a role, including early marriages, female genital mutilation (FGM), a nomadic lifestyle, and security issues, all of which hinder access to formal education.

### **2.1.3 Health**

Garissa County's health vulnerability is affected by political, socioeconomic and environmental marginalization, impacting access, adequacy, and financing of health services. Acute Respiratory Tract Infections (ARI) have the highest prevalence among children, followed by skin diseases and injuries. In 2023, one confirmed polio case was reported in refugee settlements, with four more under investigation. Key health challenges include limited health financing, high maternal mortality, inadequate youth and mental health services, substance abuse, gaps in health information, poor referrals, inadequate facilities, and a rise in gender-based violence, new HIV cases, and child pregnancies. Immunization rates declined, with infant diphtheria-tetanus-pertussis (DTP) coverage dropping from 54.4% in 2014 to 22.9% in 2022.

Maternal health services are insufficient, with only 31.2% of women receiving antenatal care four or more times, the lowest rate nationally. Essential services like supplementation for infants and mothers, as well as deworming, are also inadequate. Zinc and ORS use dropped to 33.3% in 2023, while Vitamin A supplementation for children aged 6-11 months was below the national target. Mental health services are inadequate, including the absence of a psychiatric rehabilitation centre and deworming coverage remains below the national target impacting nutrition.

Family planning use is low, with only 12.7% of women using modern methods in 2022. Barriers include myths, male influence, fear of adverse vaccine effects, COVID-19's impact on health-seeking behavior and the cost of contraceptives, particularly challenging in high-poverty areas.

### **2.1.4 Water, Hygiene and Sanitation (WASH)**

The Water, Sanitation, and Hygiene (WASH) indicators reveal serious challenges that directly impact social protection in Garissa County, particularly for vulnerable groups such as refugees, women, children, and persons with disabilities. Low latrine coverage (37%) and a high rate of open defecation (39.7%) increase the risk of waterborne diseases, which can disproportionately affect children and other vulnerable populations. Limited access to safe water (with only 57.4% of households accessing piped or protected water and only 27.6% treating it) adds to these health risks, exacerbating the county's difficulties in providing effective social protection.

Inadequate sanitation services, poor solid waste management and ageing water infrastructure strain existing resources, especially in Dadaab where reliance on the Merti aquifer and a limited number of operational boreholes (60%) place immense stress on water availability. This pressure is heightened by erratic rainfall, which affects aquifer levels and resource sustainability, limiting the ability of the county to guarantee consistent water access to all residents.

Inadequate investment in household latrine coverage (currently 52.6%) and insufficient gender-responsive WASH programs, particularly for menstrual hygiene, further compound social protection barriers. Such gaps mean that basic needs for health, dignity, and safety are unmet, affecting women and children most acutely. Addressing these WASH issues is essential to enhancing Garissa's social protection capacity, as it would not only reduce health risks but also improve the quality of life and resilience of both the refugees and host populations.

### **2.1.5 County Disaster Profile and Risk Management**

The county faces significant socio-economic challenges shaped by its fragile ecosystems, harsh climate, limited infrastructure, environmental degradation, and high poverty rates. Despite these obstacles, the county supports a considerable share of Kenya's livestock and human population. Frequent exposure to droughts, floods, and inter-community conflicts exacerbates human and livestock losses, impacting livelihoods and economic stability. Due to climate conditions, Garissa is classified as part of the "alarm stage" by the National Disaster Management Authority (NDMA), marking it among the most severely affected areas by climate change in Kenya.

Recent assessments show that drought has driven over 42,500 households out of 82% of settlements, while about 72,600 pastoralist households have lost their primary livelihood due to livestock deaths or unproductive land. This widespread displacement and loss of income severely constrain socio-economic progress and heighten vulnerabilities, limiting opportunities for poverty reduction and community resilience.

These impacts further restrict economic diversification, pushing households into deeper dependency on external aid and reducing local adaptive capacity.

In response, both national and county governments, along with development partners, have initiated preparedness and emergency response measures to meet Garissa's unique needs. Yet, recurring environmental degradation, prolonged droughts, and reduced livelihood options highlight the need for comprehensive social protection strategies. These should focus on enhancing community resilience, promoting economic diversification, and supporting sustainable social mobility to strengthen the population's capacity to withstand future climate-related challenges.

## 2.2 Social Protection in Garissa County

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This section highlights the social protection status in the county. There are 5,187 persons with disabilities in Garissa (2019, Kenya Population and Housing Census) who are more likely to live in poverty than persons without disabilities due to barriers in society such as discrimination, limited access to education and health care, unemployment, and limited inclusion in livelihood and other social programs.

Most social protection programs for special groups are domiciled under the state department of social protection. National government have semi-autonomous agencies that support special groups both for host communities and refugees, the National Council for Children Services (NCCS), National Council for Persons with Disabilities (NCPWDs), Child Welfare Society of Kenya (CWSK), Street Families Rehabilitation Trust Fund (SFRTF) and the National Assistance Trust Fund for Trafficking in Persons (TiPs).

Garissa County's high poverty levels, cross-border movement, and socioeconomic inequalities among both refugees and host communities highlight the need for robust policy and legal interventions. Vulnerable populations such as persons with disabilities, children, women, youth, orphans, elderly individuals, and people living with HIV/AIDS face heightened insecurity and limited social protection. This lack of adequate safety nets undermines efforts to build a more inclusive and prosperous economy.

Overall, the real value of the monthly grant to the children, elderly and persons with disability has dropped substantially over time due to inflation. However, given rising household vulnerabilities, it would be important to increase the coverage and maintain the real value of the cash grants to effectively respond to the emerging challenges faced by households. There is a need to adjust social grants annually, based on inflation rates to improve the standard of living of those with low incomes and thus avoid widening inequality.

### 2.2.1 Sexual and Gender Based Violence (SGBV)

Garissa county has experienced unprecedented upsurge in sexual and gender-based violence for decades. Most reported SGBV cases are rape, defilement, wife battering, Early Childhood Marriages, FGM, trafficking and sexual exploitation, and child labour. Gender-Based Violence (including domestic violence) affects about 77.4% of the Garissa County population compared to the 45.4% national average. Of significance is Female Genital Mutilation at 15% nationally. The prevalence of FGM generally increases with age; 9% of women age 15–19 have been circumcised, compared with 23% of women age 45–49 (Kenya Demographic Health Surveys 2022)

The persistent and high levels of sexual and gender-based violence (SGBV) in Garissa County underscore critical vulnerabilities that make social protection interventions essential. With a significant prevalence of SGBV, including rape, defilement, domestic violence, child marriages, female genital mutilation (FGM), trafficking, and child labor, social protection programs can provide much-needed support and resources to affected individuals and families. The high prevalence of such harmful practices reflects deep-rooted vulnerabilities, where poverty, cultural norms, and lack of education fuel cycles of violence and exploitation, particularly for women and children.

More statistics on the various forms of gender related violence in Garissa County is as indicated in table below.

**Table 2.1: Gender Related Violence in Garissa County**

| Type                                                          | Garissa (percentage) | National |
|---------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------|----------|
| Rape                                                          | 30.6                 | 19.9     |
| Possession of Drugs and/or illicit brew                       | 46.8                 | 51.6     |
| Female genital mutilation (FGM)                               | 28                   | 15       |
| Child Abuse (including child neglect) other than sexual abuse | 8.1                  | 26.9     |
| Assault Causing Actual Bodily Harm                            | 67.7                 | 34.9     |
| Gender Based Violence (including Domestic Violence)           | 77.4                 | 45.4     |
| Defilement                                                    | 51.6                 | 33.1     |

Source: National Crime Research Centre, Garissa County Crime Outlook 2020

The County is grappling with challenges including inadequate awareness on SGBV, weak SGBV Linkages and referral pathways, difficulties in accessing justice, weak engagement with law enforcement, inadequate safe structures and services for GBV survivors, weak commitment from stakeholders, absence of psycho-social and economic support for vulnerable groups for safe and secure families and communities. This is further exacerbated by inadequate county policies and regulatory framework that has an annual monetary budgeted to support programs that protect women and girls in Garissa County.

The Maslaha-a traditional mechanism of conflict resolutions amongst Somali communities- is being used by the community to arbitrate on conflicts and promote cohesion. However, it becomes counter-productive and harmful when applied on serious crimes including sexual and gender-based violence cases as it favors the perpetrators and promotes impunity.

Further the County has inadequate gender based violence statistics which hampers effective assessment of the implications of the policies and budgets, service delivery and comprehensive assessment of the impact of GBV to development

A comprehensive social protection system shall ensure measures are put in place to prevent gender based violence and to streamline the functioning of the Maslaha system for compliance with the applicable laws governing sexual offenses and to prevent its abuse as an alternative justice system (Garissa County Gender Policy)

## 2.3 Policy and Legal Framework

This part highlights the key policy, legal and regulatory frameworks that the Garissa County Social Protection is anchored on both at the global, national and county levels.

### 2.3.1 International framework

Kenya is a signatory to several international instruments and frameworks at both global and regional levels, and which are relevant to the implementation of this Policy. Article 2 (6) of the Constitution states that any treaty or convention ratified by Kenya shall form part of the Country's law. These international instruments include the Universal Declaration of Human Rights (1948) which acknowledges Social Protection as a fundamental human right,

the Convention relating to the Status of Refugees (1951), the International Covenant on Economic, Social and Cultural Rights (1967), the Protocol Relating to the Status of Refugees (1967), the African Union Convention Governing the Specific Aspects of Refugee Problems in Africa (1969), the UN Convention on the Elimination of the All Forms of Discrimination Against Women (1979), the African Charter on Human and People's Rights (1981), the UN Convention on the Rights of the Child (1990), the UN Convention on the Rights of the Persons with Disabilities (2006), the African Charter on the Rights and Welfare of the Child (1990), the Protocol on African Charter on Human and People with Disabilities, the Protocol on African Charter on Human and People Rights for Older Persons, and the International Labour Organization (ILO) Conventions and Recommendations, especially Convention 102, Recommendations 202 and 204, among others.



## 2.3.2 National Frameworks

Social Protection in Kenya is also guided by National legal frameworks. Key among them is the Constitution of Kenya (2010) and other sector-specific legislations, such as the National Social Protection Policy (2024), National Social Security Fund Act (established in 1965 and last updated in 2023), the Social Health Insurance Act 2023, the Basic Education Act (2013), the Employment Act (2023), the Retirement Benefit Authority Act 2017, the Children's Act (2022), and the Persons with Disabilities Act (2003).

## 2.3.3 County policy and legal frameworks

Garissa County government has developed and adopted the following policies and legal framework that are aimed in mitigating in extreme vulnerabilities. These are County Emergency Fund Act 2014, County Bursary Fund Act 2014, County climate change Fund Act 2018, Revolving fund Act 2018, Facility Improvement Fund Act 2024, Gender Policy 2022, Youth Development Policy 2022, Youth Agribusiness strategy 2024, County Disaster Risk Reduction Policy 2021, School Feeding Policy 2021, Livestock Marketing Policy 2022, Water Act 2019.

Despite these range of legal instruments, there are still gaps in terms of a comprehensive Social Protection, policy and legislative framework to support effective coordination across county departments, national government agencies and partners for effective and efficient delivery of Social Protection program. The legislation will also ensure that all social protection Programs especially social assistance are fully anchored in law and sustainable.

# 2.4 Stakeholder Analysis and their interventions

The table below summarizes the existing Social Assistance programs in the County. In aligning these programs, the policy document should recognize programs that exist, their varied capacities and the unique strengths that they bring on board.

*Table 2.2: Existing Social Assistance programs in the County*

| Organization        | Areas of Operation (Sub County)      | Main Activities                                                                                                                                                                                             | Remarks/Comments                         |
|---------------------|--------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------|
| National Government | County wide                          | Cash transfer to vulnerable individuals-HSNP, Inua Jami                                                                                                                                                     | Targeting the most vulnerable households |
| County Government   | All sub counties                     | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Shock interventions</li> <li>Ugatuji</li> <li>Revolving fund</li> <li>Burseries</li> <li>Skilled development</li> </ul>                                              | All vulnerable groups                    |
| UN Agencies         | County wide & Dadaab Refugee Complex | Cash transfer(CT), Skills development, Climate Shock interventions, Livelihood such as nutritional support, immunizations, providing farming inputs, drilling rehabilitation and solarization of boreholes  |                                          |
|                     | Dadaab Refugee Complex               | e Voucher                                                                                                                                                                                                   |                                          |
| KRCS                | All Sub-counties                     | Social protection program Cash transfer (CT)                                                                                                                                                                | All vulnerable groups                    |
| Partners            | All sub counties                     | Cash transfer (CT), Skills development, Climate Shock interventions, Livelihood such as nutritional support, immunizations, providing farming inputs, drilling rehabilitation and solarization of boreholes | All vulnerable groups                    |

| Organization                      | Areas of Operation (Sub County) | Main Activities                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | Remarks/Comments      |
|-----------------------------------|---------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------|
| Philanthropies                    | All subcounties                 | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• In-kind donation</li> <li>• Sadaqa</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                         | All vulnerable groups |
| Community social support programs | All subcounties                 | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Zakat programmes</li> <li>• Sadaqa programmes</li> <li>• Irmansi programme</li> <li>• Qaran/mawlaha programme</li> <li>• Tacsiiya progrmme</li> <li>• Kalmaa</li> <li>• Maslah policy</li> <li>• Hiksin programme</li> <li>• Hirsi Program</li> </ul> | All vulnerable groups |

## 2.5 Challenges

Garissa County's social protection sector faces numerous challenges that hinder effective support for its vulnerable populations. Key issues include an inadequate policy, legal and regulatory framework, coupled with weak coordination mechanisms of social protection programs, which limits their reach and impact. High poverty and illiteracy levels, along with limited awareness about social protection options, create additional barriers for residents. Socio-economic factors, such as child malnutrition, high post-harvest losses and poor access to markets, further compound household vulnerabilities.

Moreover, restrictive social norms, low uptake of health coverage, insufficient data on vulnerable groups and inadequate funding for social protection programs highlight the need for stronger support structures and enhanced community outreach.





A group of people, including children and adults, are standing in a dry, open landscape with sparse vegetation and acacia trees. A woman in a green headscarf and patterned dress is in the center, holding a stick. To her left, a child in a white shirt and shorts stands. Further left, a person in a pink patterned dress is visible. On the far left, a person in an orange shirt stands near a yellow cloth. In the background, a small, dark, conical shelter is visible under a cloudy sky. The overall scene suggests a rural or semi-arid environment.

# 03

## **Policy Issues, Objectives and Strategies**



This policy recognizes the need for appropriate strategies in tackling the identified challenges for the successful realization of social protection objectives in Garissa County. This chapter outlines the policy objectives, directions and strategies for addressing the issues identified in the first two chapters about the goal of ensuring social protection of the poor and vulnerable in the County. These objectives, directions and strategies provide specific guidance on how the overall goals and statements of this policy will be attained. The County Government of Garissa shall put in place the necessary policy, legislative and regulatory framework for a harmonized social protection programs in the County. The County Government shall also seek strategic partnerships with stakeholders to advance social protection and explore ways of reducing poverty, increasing income for the residents and empowering the vulnerable groups in the County.

## 3.2 Policy Direction

For this Policy, Social Protection refers to: “The set of policies, programs, interventions, and legislative measures aimed at cushioning all the residents of Garissa County against poverty, vulnerability, exclusion, risks, contingencies, and shocks throughout their life cycles, and promoting the realization of economic and social rights.”

Given the above, this Policy has reorganized Social Protection in the County into four Pillars:



**Pillar 1:** Income Security

**Pillar 2:** Social Health Protection

**Pillar 3:** Shock-Responsive Social Protection

**Pillar 4:** Complementary Programs

## 3.3 Policy Objectives

This policy shall serve as the reference point to stakeholders in the design, implementation, monitoring and evaluation of social protection programs in the county. The priority areas of focus are income security, social health protection, shock-responsive social protection and complementary programs. To attain this, the following policy objectives will be pursued:

1. To improve income security for vulnerable populations facing economic hardships across all ages and diversities through integration of social assistance with interventions that promote sustainable livelihoods practices.
2. To enhance universal health coverage for the residents of Garissa County .
3. To cushion vulnerable populations against risk and shocks.
4. To foster empowerment that will contribute to an inclusive and cohesive society that respects diversity, promotes peaceful coexistence and enables the active participation of citizens in decision-making processes.
5. To ensure sustainable and effective resource mobilization, collaboration and strategic partnerships and comprehensive planning for the successful implementation of social protection programs in Garissa County.

## 3.4 Income Security

The Income Security Pillar includes a combination of contributory and non-contributory Social Protection programs to cushion all citizens against risks and contingencies they face throughout their life cycle. Thus, it also intends to prevent and protect individuals and households from falling into poverty and promote and transform their lives and livelihoods for enhanced social justice and cohesion.

The pillar intends to prevent and protect individuals and households from falling into poverty and promote and transform their lives and livelihoods for enhanced social justice and cohesion. Pooling together in a coherent manner, Social protection interventions and programs shall enable Garissa county move towards the attainment of meeting SDG 1.3 by 2030, MTP IV 3.3.2 and to achieve its set goals in the third generation CIDP by Enhancing Social protection.

Income security initiatives aim to address the specific vulnerabilities faced by various population groups, enhancing economic stability and resilience. The key intervention areas include:

- **Protection for Children:** These interventions will target children in poor and vulnerable households, ensuring basic support for their wellbeing.
- **Protection for Persons with Disabilities:** Tailored income security interventions will assist low-income households with disabled members to address their unique economic and social needs.
- **Assistance for the Unemployed and Low-Income Workers:** Support for working-age individuals facing unemployment or low income helps reduce economic vulnerability and provides stability.
- **Support for Forcibly Displaced Persons:** Targeted assistance addresses the specific needs of refugees and asylum seekers who face added risks due to displacement.
- **Employee Injury and Disease Benefits:** This component ensures income protection for workers affected by job-related injuries or illnesses.
- **Maternity Income Protection:** Provides income support for women during maternity leave to enhance family security and stability.
- **Old-Age Benefits:** This category aims to protect the elderly, with expanded retirement schemes to increase coverage and benefit levels.
- **Survivors of Gender based violence:** This Category includes support for survivors of gender based violence.

## Policy Measures/interventions

The County Government of Garissa, working with all other stakeholders, shall:

1. Enhance coordination mechanisms, financing, and institutional frameworks necessary to provide both contributory and non-contributory benefits to all residents of Garissa.
2. Expand the implementation of social assistance transfers, care and support systems, economic and financial inclusion programs by enhancing the county participation.
3. Improve the efficiency, effectiveness, and accessibility of benefit delivery systems.
4. Regularly adjust social assistance benefits to reflect changes in the cost of living and other relevant factors.
5. Advocate social security coverage for all workers and their dependents, in both formal and informal sectors.
6. The county to compliment the national government interventions on the uptake of the National Social Security Fund (NSSF) program through sensitization.
7. Develop innovative mechanisms for the efficient and effective management of social security contributions and benefits.
8. Ensure transparency and accountability in both contributory and non-contributory social protection schemes.
9. Support agricultural social protection programs such as subsidies on farm inputs among others.
10. Establish livestock restocking and pasture development programs interventions for affected communities.
11. Link communities with national and county enterprise funds and strengthen access to affordable investment loans, grants for youth and women and access to government opportunities AGPO.
12. Establish and implement social protection information and knowledge management systems.
13. Mainstream social protection in all sectors and programs and enhance coordination at the national and county government levels.

## 3.5 Social Health Protection

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Garissa County's Social Health Protection policy aims to achieve universal health coverage (UHC) by ensuring access to essential health services for all residents without financial hardship. This policy aligns with Kenya's Constitution, Vision 2030, and global health commitments. It upholds Article 43 of the Constitution, focusing on expanding social health insurance coverage, enhancing healthcare access, and offering financial protection against health-related expenses.

The County is committed to providing universal healthcare in public facilities, regardless of socio-economic status. By implementing UHC, Garissa aims to reduce medical costs and promote health equity, with particular focus on marginalized groups, such as women, children, the elderly, persons with disabilities, and ethnic minorities. Under the Social Health Insurance (SHI) scheme, vulnerable populations will receive a broad range of health benefits to address social exclusion and promote equal health rights.

To foster inclusivity, especially between host communities and refugees, Garissa County will support UHC/SHI in line with the national agenda, prioritizing social assistance beneficiaries and informal sector workers.

This approach includes strengthening registration systems to boost SHI uptake and mobilizing community awareness on the benefits of social health insurance.

### Policy Measures/interventions

The County Government of Garissa, working with all other stakeholders, shall:

1. Establish and implement a health insurance coverage and health service provision to poor and vulnerable groups, informal and rural workers to achieve the realization of UHC in the county.
2. Enhance public and community awareness on the importance of Universal Health Care.
3. Advocate and provide emergency referral to maternal and other emergency conditions that threaten life among the Population County and inter-county health referral system.
4. Advocate and promote uptake and access to psycho-social and palliative support
5. Promote the integration of nutrition-sensitive interventions in social health protection and support equitable distribution of health and nutrition commodities, supplies and human resource
6. Support the development and strengthening of mechanisms for occupational safety and health to prevent and compensate for work injuries and diseases.
7. Develop social-health protection measures that address harmful cultural practices (female genital mutilation (FGM), early child pregnancies, early child marriages, drug and substance abuse, unskilled home deliveries
8. Support and strengthen existing and create new collaborations for social health protection.
9. Promote the application of advanced technologies such as GIS to map healthcare needs.
10. Strengthen and support Universal health coverage through increased local and refugee population enrolment into the SHI scheme.
11. Mapping and registering community members including the vulnerable members and persons with special needs who are eligible to be supported under the SHIF scheme to take advantage of UHC.
12. Jointly work with social health Insurance authority to ensure public and NGO health facilities are accredited and start accessing funds under the schemes to provide universal health coverage.
13. Advocate for the establishment and maintenance of well-equipped psychiatric healthcare facilities in urban and rural areas.
14. Advocate for the availability of essential medicines and medical supplies at affordable prices.
15. Advocate and enhance financial risk protection, for all beneficiaries, including the poor and vulnerable groups.
16. Enhanced Accessibility and Learning Support for Children with Disabilities and Empowerment Through Assistive Devices, Rehabilitation, and Vocational Training.
17. Facilitate and support the development and implementation of mechanisms to extend social health insurance for forcibly displaced persons (refugees and asylum seekers).

## 3.6 Shock-Responsive Social Protection

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Shock-responsive social Protection is designed to assist populations impacted by crises through specialized social protection programs and administrative frameworks. This pillar focuses on systems and policies to enable swift responses to shocks and crises, such as natural and human-induced disasters, economic downturns, pandemics, or forced displacement. The aim is to provide timely relief and protection, enabling affected individuals and households to cope with immediate impacts, recover more quickly, and avoid resorting to harmful coping strategies such as asset sales, child labor, or early marriage.

Shock-responsive interventions are typically time-bound, facilitating recovery and building resilience to help people return to stability. For effective rapid response, these interventions will be embedded within existing relevant national and county policies and frameworks. Garissa County aims to strengthen its preparedness by gradually integrating shock-responsive interventions, including cash-based transfers, into the systems of ongoing Social Assistance programs.

Garissa's experience with shock-responsive programs leverages trigger mechanisms from national government agencies and early warning systems to address crises, particularly those related to climate change, natural disasters, and forced displacement. This pillar seeks to establish new social protection programs and enhance collaboration with the national government and partners to better respond to shocks and risks affecting Garissa's population.

The approach emphasizes social inclusion, integrating marginalized groups and refugees into programs, and applying human rights, disability, and gender-sensitive approaches. Collaborations with humanitarian agencies, especially in supporting refugees, will ensure that all vulnerable populations are protected during emergencies and crises, with recognition of how vulnerabilities vary across genders.

### Policy Measures/Interventions

The County Government of Garissa, working with all other stakeholders, shall:

1. Improve emergency preparedness by strengthening trigger systems and Early Warning Action mechanisms to inform appropriate response options and expand responsive Social Protection interventions across the county.
2. Establish and utilize the County's Social Protection Management Information System (CSPMIS) and integrate it with Geographic Information System (GIS) and leverage on the existing National Government Systems including the Enhanced Single Registry.
3. Strengthen linkages between emergency response mechanisms and interventions that enhance resilience and adaptive capacity at all levels.
4. Layer and integrate the relevant policy, legal frameworks and strategies to enhance coordination, collaboration and networking with humanitarian agencies and other relevant stakeholders in the provision of humanitarian support and implementation of inclusive shock-responsive Social Protection interventions.
5. Provide psycho-social support initiatives to cushion against socio-economic shocks and risk.
6. Enhance the County's capacity to mainstream human rights, refugee integration, disability and gender transformative approaches in all shock responsive interventions.
7. Design and implement shock-responsive recovery program like restocking and seed packages to enhance communities' capacities to bounce back from shocks and stresses.
8. Design and implement shock responsive disability packages targeting persons with disability affected by disasters across the county.
9. Advocate for provision of supplementary feeding program targeting children under five, pregnant and lactating women to enhance preventive measures and treatment for malnutrition.
10. Provide supplementary school feeding initiatives to cushion school going children whenever there are disasters.
11. Design and implement in kind support to households affected with malnutrition and households affected by disasters classified under integrated phase classification for food security
12. Support the development and implementation of mechanisms to extend social health insurance for forcibly displaced persons (refugees and asylum seekers).
13. Strengthen and expand the cash transfers by ensuring the county contribution through devising social protection programs such as social protection funds.



## 3.7 Complementary Programs

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This Pillar comprises of interventions aimed at addressing specific needs and vulnerabilities of communities within Garissa County. These programs work alongside other social protection interventions to enhance resilience, reduce vulnerabilities, and improve the overall wellbeing of residents. It seeks to facilitate access to services such as healthcare, nutrition, and education among others. It further promotes livelihoods, skills training, fosters labor and socio-economic inclusion, and builds resilience among residents of Garissa County while highlighting other specific programs led by the County Government departments which complement those provided by the National Government and development partners.

The pillar takes cognizance of the efforts by the national government through various department such as the Department for Refugee Services, to enhance host communities and refugees integration. Efforts will be made to tap into the interventions designed to facilitate the integration identified under the GISED P and Shirika plan.

In addition, linkages with economic inclusion interventions and labour market policies can boost ownership of productive assets and facilitate access to jobs, particularly for the youth. To create synergies and boost the impacts of these complementary programs, it is necessary to foster a coherent approach that relies on the integration between income security and broader social protection policies. Setting up coordination mechanisms to achieve this objective at county levels will be one of the most important missions of the various sectors contributing to the Social Protection System in the coming years.

The county's high levels of absolute poverty severely limit vulnerable populations' access to essential resources like food, healthcare, water, sanitation, education, nutrition, and housing. This deprivation highlights the urgent need for robust social protection measures to bolster resilience. Additionally, high illiteracy levels hinder both youth and adults in securing quality employment and reducing poverty. Addressing inequalities, marginalization and SGBV in the county requires targeted interventions promoting equity, social inclusion, justice, and equality within local communities. These efforts aim to reduce disparities and ensure equal access to opportunities, resources, and services for all residents.

This Policy proposes several complementary interventions that can be implemented independently or as integrated programs.



# 04

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## **Policy Coordination and Implementation, Partnership and Resource Mobilization**

**This chapter addresses ways of bringing together various stakeholders who play critical role in social protection and their roles, and sustainable funding for Social protection. This is with a view to ensure harmonized coordination and effectiveness of the social protection priorities in Garissa County.**

## **4.1 Policy Coordination and Implementation**

Ineffective coordination of social protection programs has led to redundancy, overlap, delays in task completion, and inefficient use of resources. Establishing an effective coordination mechanism is essential to address these challenges and improve efficiency within the County. The department responsible for social protection in Garissa County shall implement the following measures for enhanced coordination;

1. Establish a County social protection coordination mechanism
2. Establish public participation and social protection community engagement forums
3. Establish and support necessary institutions and structures for efficient and effective coordination and management of social protection programs.
4. Promote integration, inclusion of special interest groups such as refugees, PWDS, marginalized and minorities in all structures established and programmatic planning and implementation.

### **4.1.1 Coordination Structures**

The county government will set up coordination structures at the county, sub-county, ward, and village levels to oversee the implementation of Social Protection programs. More specifically, this Policy recommends the establishment of the following structures:

1. County Social Protection Coordination Committee
2. County Social Protection technical working group
3. Sub-County Social Protection Committee
4. Ward Social Protection Committee

### **4.1.2 County Social Protection Committee**

The county social protection committee is composed of the following members;

- a. The County Executive Committee Member for social protection, who shall be the Chairperson;
- b. The Chief Officer for social protection, who shall be the Secretary.
- c. The Chief Officer responsible for finance or a representative designated in writing;
- d. The Chief Officer responsible for health or a representative designated in writing
- e. The Chief Officer responsible for special programs or a representative designated in writing
- f. The Chief Officer responsible for agriculture and livestock or a representative designated in writing
- g. The County attorney or a representative designated in writing;
- h. The County Commissioner or a representative designated in writing;
- i. A representative of the National Gender and Equality Commission;
- j. One person nominated by faith-based organizations, registered in the county; and
- k. One person nominated by non-state actors implementing social protection programs in the county.



**The functions of the County Social Protection Coordination Committee are;**

1. Coordination of the various social protection activities in Garissa County.
2. Undertake and promote the integration of social protection into sectoral development policies, plans, programs, and projects.
3. Strengthen the capacity of stakeholders and county officials in the area of social protection to ensure that all stakeholders are well-equipped to carry out their mandates.
4. Develop and enhance efficient complaints and feedback mechanisms for effective case management, including integration with national case management systems.
5. Prepare and submit a bi-annual report on the status of Social Protection in Garissa County to the County executive committee member
6. Facilitate and support the establishment and operationalization of coordination committees at the sub-county level.
7. Undertake resource mobilization and funding support for social protection at the county level.

### **4.1.3 County Social Protection Technical Working Group**

The county social protection technical working group is composed of the following members;

1. Chief officer Social Protection department chairperson
2. Director for social protection who is the Secretary
3. Director of Finance
4. Director for health
5. Director for early childhood education
6. Director Economic planning
7. Director livestock
8. Director Devolved units
9. County Director of children services
10. County coordinator for NCPWD
11. UN Agencies with social protection programs
12. Civil society organizations with social protection programs
13. Representative of a faith-based organization

**Functions of the County Social Protection Technical Working Group shall include.**

1. Liaise with relevant departments common management information system (MIS) and county-specific single registry for social protection to enhance beneficiary screening, registration, validation, verification, and data management
2. Undertake dissemination of the policy to the Garissa County residents and to other stakeholders.
3. Monitor and evaluate activities, including those conducted by all stakeholders and partners, to ensure adherence to agreed-upon standards.
4. Establish and maintain an effective advocacy, communication and influencing system on social protection issues.
5. Conduct and coordinate research, investigations, and surveys on social protection in the county, collecting, collating, analyzing, and disseminating the findings.
6. Support the undertaking of social protection identification and profiling of social protection beneficiaries.
7. Give technical advice to the county social protection coordination committee on social protection in the county.
8. Enforce standards relating to social protection programs and management including areas of research and information sharing.
9. Oversee the implementation of social protection programs decisions agreed at the County Social Protection Coordination Committee.
10. Coordinate monitoring and evaluation of social protection activities.
11. Periodically lead organized policy reviews.



#### 4.1.4 Sub-County Social Protection Committee

The sub-county social protection Technical Working Group shall comprise.

1. The sub-county administrator who shall be the chairperson
2. The Deputy County Commissioner who will co-chair
3. A representative of the county department for social protection, who shall be the secretary;
4. A representative of the county department for health;
5. A representative of the Department of Social Protection, in the national government.
6. One person nominated by faith-based organizations registered in the sub-county;
7. One person nominated by non-state actors implementing social protection programs in the sub-county;
8. One person representing the youth nominated by the county department for youth affairs; and
9. One person representing organizations of persons with disabilities.
10. Where a sub-county is designated to host refugees under the Refugees Act 2021, the membership of the sub-county TWG shall include a representative of the Department of refugee services.

**Functions of the sub-County Social Protection Committee include;**

1. Support the County SP technical working and Coordination committee to put in place systems to oversight the delivery of SP in the respective sub-county.
2. Support the assessments, monitoring, social audits, and alignment of social protection programs
3. Build a coherent and collaborative sub-county-level system for addressing emerging challenges on social protection in collaboration with key stakeholders.
4. Facilitate/support the establishment and operationalization of coordination committees at the Ward level.
5. Undertake any other role assigned by the County Social Protection technical working group and the Co-ordination committee.
6. Foster linkages with non-state actors and sub-county community grassroots representatives who have an interest in social protection programs.

#### 4.1.5 Ward Social Protection Committee

The Ward Social Protection Committee shall comprise—

1. The ward administrator who shall be the chairperson
2. The Assistant County Commissioner
3. A representative of the County Department for Social Protection, who shall be the secretary
4. A representative from the Department of health.
5. One representative of faith-based organizations.
6. One representative of the youth, nominated by the youth;
7. One representative of persons with disabilities nominated by an association of persons with disabilities;
8. One representative of women; and
9. One representative of elders in the ward
10. Representative of civil society organization with social protection programs at the ward

**Functions of the Ward Social Protection Committee includes:-**

1. Support coordination and integration of social protection interventions at the ward level.
2. Facilitate the establishment and operationalization of coordination committees at the village level.
3. Support coordination and integration of social protection interventions at the village level.

4. Enhance and strengthen the Indigenous social protection programs at the ward level.
5. Conduct Community awareness and sensitization on social protection interventions implemented by various actors.
6. Conduct a social vulnerability assessment with the aim of mapping, identifying and registering potential beneficiaries.

## 4.2 Partnership

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The county department responsible for social protection shall work closely with both state and non-state actors as well as other relevant stakeholders. The county government will seek strategic relationships with the following categories of stakeholders whose roles are summaries as below:

### **Government Line Ministries/departments and agencies**

- Resource allocation for policy implementations
- Enactment of related legislative/policy frameworks
- Check and balances on the implementation by the executive
- Capacity building for the department on matters of social protection.
- Development of Information, Education and Communication (IEC) materials on social protection.
- Establish the relevant infrastructure for persons with disabilities.
- Enhance collaborations and partnerships with stakeholders.
- Coordination and implementation of Social Health Protection Programs.
- Undertake Monitoring and Evaluation, accountability, and Learning.

### **Non-governmental organizations**

Are Service providers (e.g. Alliance Networks, Refugee Consortium of Kenya) in social protection interventions

- Support Garissa County in implementation of social protection programs.
- Participate and provide support to Garissa County in CIDP implementation and annual budget reviews.
- Participation in data collection and analysis, including undertaking research and surveys on social protection.
- Resource mobilization for SP policy implementation.
- Advocate for social protection interventions
- Design appropriate programs and interventions to supplement County programs.

### **Media**

- Serves as a public information provider and analysis on enforcement of social protection policies and legislation;
- Awareness creation on matters social protection.

### **United Nations Agencies and other Humanitarian Agencies and Development partners**

- Support in response to emergencies
- Early warning information
- Support the delivery of social protection interventions to affected communities.

### **Private Sector**

- Engagement in Public-private partnerships and CSR towards components of social protection
- Provide financial and technical support to the County in implementation of social protection programs.
- Participation in data collection on social protection trends in the county.

### **Organizations of and for persons with disabilities**

- Provide technical and financial support towards the implementation of social protection programs and ensuring disability inclusion at all levels.

### **Communities**

- Providing financial support to the vulnerable groups through existing indigenous community structures and norms.
- Create awareness and sensitization of the existing community social protection mechanisms.
- Assist in data collection on the needs and capacities of vulnerable groups.

### **Constitutional Commissions/ Independent Offices**

This includes, but not limited to National Gender and Equality Commission, Kenya National Commission on Human Rights, Independent Policing Oversight Authority, Office of the Director of Public Prosecution and the Judiciary.

- Monitor all aspect relating to right of vulnerable groups in the county.
- Investigate complains emerging from social protection programme implementation in Garissa.
- Implement policy in line with their mandate.

### **Trade unions**

- Negotiate better social protection schemes for all workers.
- Create awareness and sensitization of the existing social protection mechanisms to formally employed workers and informal sector workers.
- Disseminate the policy to the workers.
- Provide technical support in the review and implementation of the policy.

## **4.3 Resource Mobilization**

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Increased government financing for social protection will help to realize the county, national and global aspirations/agenda in social protection such as county and national policies and relevant SDGs. With well-financed social protection system, inequalities among the residents will reduce, wellbeing will improve in addition to economic growth and development.

The social protection fund will ensure the sustainable funding for social protection through the following sources:

1. Equitable share
2. National Drought Emergency Fund (NDEF) under NDMA
3. Relevant ministries for complementary programs
4. Social insurance contributions.
5. Grants, gifts or donations from strategic partners
6. Kafala or sponsorships from well-wishers

The county government shall aim to expand sources of financing for social protection through strategic partnerships and engagement. The County Government shall endeavor to:

- a. Ensure that adequate resources are allocated to social protection in a predictable, gradual and long-term manner.
- b. Encourage the use of devolved funds for implementing social protection.
- c. Enhance the effectiveness, cost efficiency and sustainable financing of social protection;
- d. Strengthen collaboration with stakeholders in social protection financing;
- e. Enhance mechanisms for accountability in social protection financing.
- f. The development of joint work plans and joint review missions would be critical in avoiding duplication between stakeholders and the county government and provide oversight.

# 05

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## **Monitoring, Evaluation, Reporting, learning and Review**



**The chapter highlights the aspects of monitoring, evaluation, reporting, community complaints & feedback mechanisms and policy review. An effective monitoring and evaluation framework will improve accountability, transparency, and the overall impact of interventions aimed at reducing poverty, promoting social inclusion, and enhancing the well-being of vulnerable populations. To ensure a comprehensive framework, adequate data and timely measurable indicators capable of tracking the performance of the social protection system are necessary.**

**A policy implementation matrix will guide the stakeholders in understanding the outcomes envisioned, key interventions as well as progress measuring indicators to ensure up-to-date tracking.**

**To ensure that interventions are effectively implemented, achieving their intended outcomes, and meeting the needs of vulnerable populations at the county level, the Garissa County Government shall have the following in place.**

## **5.1 Monitoring and Evaluation (M&E) Framework**

Establishing standardized indicators, interoperable Information Management Systems, and regularly analyzing essential data are crucial for monitoring, evaluating, and assessing the impact of Social Protection programs.

The Garissa County department of Economic Planning and monitoring and evaluation will implement a robust social protection policy M&E framework integrated to the CIMES, incorporating a blend of human rights, Orphans and Vulnerable Children (OVC), disability, Minorities, Forcibly Displaced Persons (FDP/refugees), and gender indicators to gauge the effectiveness of social protection programs.

This framework will be informed by a policy implementation matrix that offers a clear guide on anticipated outcomes, strategic interventions, and measurable indicators for tracking progress.

## **5.2 Reporting**

The county government of Garissa will develop a Social Protection Management Information System (SPMIS) and link it to the Geographic Information System (GIS). This integration will enhance precise targeting, eliminating any potential for overlapping support for beneficiaries, thus leading to improved reporting. The SPMIS will be linked to the National Social Protection database, enhancing single registry, and providing robust data for both county and national-level safety net programs. Additionally, the integrated system will enhance data repositories, beneficiary screening, validation, and verification processes. This integration will also improve data management and facilitate responsive case management and timely reporting quarterly.

## **5.3 Learning**

### **5.3.1 Data Sharing and Knowledge Dissemination**

The County Government will establish a county-specific social protection data-sharing mechanism that facilitates learning and ensures alignment with both national and international forums for knowledge exchange. The data sharing mechanisms developed by the county government of Garissa will be aligned and abide by the Kenya Data Protection Act, 2019.

### **5.3.2 Research and Capacity Building**

Research will be promoted to generate evidence that supports informed policy decisions. This will be coupled with capacity-building initiatives for M&E at the county and departmental levels, ensuring a skilled workforce to oversee social protection implementation.

### 5.3.3 Socio-Economic Surveys and Oversight

Socio-economic surveys within the County will be conducted with social protection-specific indicators to provide detailed insights into the program's reach and impact. Additionally, the county's oversight role will be reinforced to maintain high standards of implementation and accountability.

### 5.3.4 Communication and Feedback Mechanisms

In Garissa County, fostering a well-informed community on social protection is paramount. To this end, the county will focus establishing a communication strategy aimed at empowering the beneficiaries of the social protection programs. The communication mechanism will provide program beneficiaries with comprehensive information about social protection initiatives, their rights, and entitlements, and ensuring they have access to a user-friendly, accessible, and efficient complaints and grievance redress mechanism. By implementing these strategies, Garissa County aims to cultivate a well-informed citizenry equipped with the tools and knowledge to navigate the social protection landscape effectively.

## 5.4 Policy Review

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A participatory policy review will be conducted every five years to assess the policy's impact and identify necessary adjustments to enhance its effectiveness







The background of the page features a close-up of hands holding several paper cutouts of human figures. The cutouts are in various colors, including gold, silver, and white. The hands are positioned as if they are carefully placing or holding the cutouts, which are arranged in a way that suggests a group or community. The overall tone is warm and supportive.

# 06

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## **Financing of Social Protection Initiatives**



**Article 20 (5) of the Constitution indicates that the State must allocate sufficient resources to ensure the achievement of Constitutional Rights. Article 43, on Economic and Social rights, states that “in allocating resources, the State shall give priority to ensuring the widest possible enjoyment of the right or fundamental freedom having regard to prevailing circumstances, including the vulnerability of particular groups or individuals”. However, attention should be paid to its affordability, and sustainability and to building synergies through enhanced cross-sectoral coordination and coherence to improve both the effectiveness and efficiency of the Social Protection expenditure. Implementation of Garissa County social protection requires substantial resources which implies not only consolidating efforts to mobilize resources from currently available sources but also identifying more innovative approaches of revenue mobilization. It is also imperative that the county government strive to maximize collection from all existing sources while exploring all other opportunities. At any given point, the county shall safeguard the income security, social care, and welfare as well as cushion the vulnerable populations from falling into extreme poverty. This will be made possible by the county making intentional investments for sustainable social protection programs.**

## 6.1 Social Protection Financing Status

In the analysis of FY23/24 budget, Garissa County allocated Ksh. 566 million (5.5 percent of the county budget) towards supporting social protection related interventions. This allocation was mainly in; school feeding, Ugatuzi na Kazi, Emergencies, Education bursary, Donations and County Health Promoters program. Additionally, the County has put in place notable legislations that are geared towards enhancing social protection interventions. These include the following: County emergency fund act 2014 allocation 2% of the county budget to emergency/shock interventions; County bursary Fund act that allocate resources to support vulnerable families' children to access education; Environmental Restoration and Livelihood act that provides capital for start-up businesses to create opportunities for youth, women and Person with Disability; and Facility Improvement Fund act aimed at enhancing efficiency in front-line health service delivery. However, this has not been adequately targeting the most vulnerable individual populations.

## 6.2 Strategies of financing

Financing of Social Protection in Garissa County shall consider innovative ways of allocating resources, mobilizing from other partners and strengthen synergies with the national government and private sector. In this regard the County Government shall develop a clear resource mobilization framework and a road map for expanding social protection resources.

The County Government shall endeavor to:-

- a. Strengthen the social protection interventions by establishing Garissa County Social Protection Fund that complements that cash transfers and other support undertaken by the national government and non-state actors.
- b. Strengthen collaboration with development partners, Private sectors, and other stakeholders in Social Protection financing.
- c. Establish a robust resource mobilization plan that will be informed by Garissa County costed social protection priorities and making projections for annual incremental budget.
- d. Improve efficiency, strengthen collaboration and coordination in mainstreaming all social protection interventions across all sectors.
- e. Develop evidence-based advocacy framework and lobby for continuous prioritization and financing of social protection initiatives.
- f. Operationalize a Finance Risk Management Framework that ensures accountability, transparency, and integrity in the sector at the county level.













